

**SMART AMRITA HACKATHON 2026 | PROJECT EXPO***Guidelines for Students*

The Project Expo is a demonstration-based component of Smart Amrita Hackathon (SAH) 2026. It invites students to exhibit **existing and ongoing projects** before an expert jury of faculty, researchers and industry professionals. Unlike the hackathon track, it does not require a new build — it recognises work already developed and creates a pathway to awards, IP support, industry connect and startup incubation.

**1. Objectives**

- Showcase outstanding student projects, prototypes and technological solutions across departments.
- Encourage engineering innovation, problem-solving and interdisciplinary collaboration.
- Enable structured evaluation by faculty, researchers and external industry experts.
- Identify projects with potential for patenting, commercialisation, industry deployment or startup development.

**2. Eligibility — Who Can Apply?**

| Criterion           | Requirement                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Who may apply       | Students of any B.Tech, M.Tech or PhD programme, in any year of study.                                                                                                                                             |
| Team size           | 2–3 students per project. Interdisciplinary teams across departments are strongly encouraged.                                                                                                                      |
| Faculty mentor      | Mandatory. A faculty mentor from any department must endorse the project, certifying student authorship and demonstration readiness.                                                                               |
| Project stage       | Ongoing or completed, and sufficiently developed for a live demonstration before the jury.                                                                                                                         |
| Entries per student | A student may be part of not more than two Project Expo teams.                                                                                                                                                     |
| Projects accepted   | Final-year, capstone and mini-projects with significant innovation; course-based projects with substantial engineering implementation; interdisciplinary projects; and independently developed student prototypes. |

**3. Project Scope**

**Qualifying output.** A project qualifies if it demonstrates at least one of the following: *a functional hardware prototype or device; a working software application or platform; an integrated hardware–software system; a robotics or automation system; an AI/ML implementation with demonstrable output; an IoT or cyber-physical system; a validated experimental setup with measurable results; or a simulation or engineering design with verified performance.*

**Domains** (*indicative, not restrictive*). AI & Machine Learning · Data Science & Computing · Electronics & Embedded Systems · IoT & Cyber-Physical Systems · Communication & Signal Processing · VLSI & Semiconductor Technologies · Robotics & Automation · Healthcare & Biomedical Technology · Energy & Sustainable Technologies · Advanced Materials & Nanotechnology · Smart Manufacturing · Smart Campus Solutions · Environmental & Social Innovation · Interdisciplinary Technologies · Open Innovation.

**Essential condition.** The project must have sufficient technical maturity for a meaningful live demonstration and technical discussion with the jury. Concept posters, literature surveys and video-only submissions without a functioning system will **not** be accepted.

**4. Selection Process and Key Dates**

The Project Expo will be held on **Thursday, 10 September 2026**. All deadlines close at 5.00 p.m. on the date indicated. No extensions will be granted.

| # | Stage                                  | Description                                                                                                                                    | Date                  |
|---|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| 1 | Call for Projects & Registration Opens | Event coordinators invite students to nominate existing and ongoing projects. Online registration opens.                                       | Mon, 24 Aug 2026      |
| 2 | Registration Closes                    | Last date for entries, with project title, team and mentor details. Late entries will not be considered.                                       | Mon, 31 Aug 2026      |
| 3 | Documentation Submission               | Shortlisted teams shall submit the Project Information Sheet and supporting technical documents as per the stipulated template.                | Sat, 5 Sep 2026       |
| 4 | Screening & Shortlisting               | Screening committees review all entries for relevance, technical merit, innovation, completeness and demonstration potential.                  | Sun–Mon, 6–7 Sep 2026 |
| 5 | Announcement of Shortlist              | Selected teams are notified and Project IDs are allotted.                                                                                      | Mon, 7 Sep 2026       |
| 6 | Project Expo & Jury Evaluation         | <b>Selected projects are exhibited and demonstrated live before visitors and the expert jury, and evaluated using the rubric in Section 5.</b> | Thu, 10 Sep 2026      |
| 7 | Awards & Opportunity Mapping           | Winners announced. Projects with strong potential are referred for IP/patent support, industry connect, incubation or the SAH Startup Pitch.   | Thu, 10 Sep 2026      |

## 5. Evaluation Rubric

Each project is evaluated out of 50 marks during the live demonstration and technical interaction.

| Criterion                        | Marks | What the Jury Looks For                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Problem Definition & Objectives  | 5     | Clarity and relevance of the problem; well-defined, measurable objectives; appropriate scope.                     |
| Design & Technical Approach      | 10    | Soundness of methodology and architecture; justification of technology choices; depth of technical understanding. |
| Build Quality & Completeness     | 15    | Quality of the prototype; degree of completion; integration, reliability and functional completeness.             |
| Live Demonstration & Performance | 10    | Actual working of the system; testing, validation and measured performance; ability to explain results.           |
| Application Value & Scalability  | 5     | Real-world relevance and user benefit; industry or social application; scalability and deployment potential.      |
| Presentation & Documentation     | 5     | Clarity of communication; quality of documentation and display; response to jury questions.                       |
| Total                            | 50    |                                                                                                                   |

**Note:** Every team member must be able to explain their individual contribution and clearly distinguish student-developed components from externally sourced hardware, software, libraries or datasets.

## 6. Award Categories and Recognition

Each category carries a **Winner** and a **Runner-Up**, determined by the expert jury on the basis of the rubric in Section 5 and the technical interaction at the stall.

| # | Structure  | Award Category       | Basis                                                   |
|---|------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Excellence | Best Overall Project | Highest overall performance across all rubric criteria. |

| #  | Structure                | Award Category                        | Basis                                                                                           |
|----|--------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2  | Innovation & Engineering | <b>Best Innovation</b>                | Most original and creative approach to a clearly identified problem.                            |
| 3  | Innovation & Engineering | <b>Best Working Prototype</b>         | Fully functional, well-demonstrated system with strong performance and practical usability.     |
| 4  | Innovation & Engineering | <b>Best Technical Implementation</b>  | Depth in engineering design, fabrication or coding, integration, testing and optimisation.      |
| 5  | Collaboration            | <b>Best Interdisciplinary Project</b> | Effective integration of two or more disciplines into a stronger solution.                      |
| 6  | Industry & Enterprise    | <b>Best Industry-Relevant Project</b> | Addresses a genuine industry problem with clear potential for adoption or deployment.           |
| 7  | Industry & Enterprise    | <b>Best Startup Potential</b>         | Viable product or venture, assessed on market need, scalability and feasibility.                |
| 8  | Impact                   | <b>Best Social Impact Project</b>     | Addresses a societal, healthcare, accessibility, rural or community challenge.                  |
| 9  | Impact                   | <b>Best Sustainable Technology</b>    | Contributes to environmental sustainability, clean energy, efficiency or resource conservation. |
| 10 | Emerging Talent          | <b>Young Innovator Award</b>          | Most promising project from a first- or second-year team.                                       |

**Certificates and medals.** Winner and Runner-Up team members will each receive a medal and a certificate. All participants will receive e-participation certificates.

**Award eligibility.** A project may receive one category award only, and the Best Overall Project winner is not eligible for any other category. If deserving projects are not found in a particular category, the award will not be conferred — this applies to both Winner and Runner-Up positions. The decision of the jury is final.

## 7. General Information

**Exhibition display.** Mandatory at the stall: project title and Project ID, team members, faculty mentor, department, the working prototype or system, a short description, key innovation, major results and applications. Recommended: system architecture diagram, key performance metrics, and a QR code linking to a demonstration video or repository.

**Backup demonstration.** Every team must carry a backup — demonstration video, screenshots, sample datasets or recorded results. This is a contingency for technical failure at the venue and does not substitute for a live demonstration.

**Safety.** Teams must ensure safe operation of all demonstrations. Projects involving high voltage or current, batteries, motors, lasers, chemicals, biological materials, pressurised systems, heat-generating equipment, rotating machinery or sharp components must be declared at registration and cleared by the Organising Committee, which may prohibit any demonstration considered unsafe.

**Academic integrity.** Projects must be original student work. Teams must acknowledge external resources, cite software, libraries and datasets used, declare AI-assisted development as required by institutional policy, and present no fabricated results. Misrepresentation of third-party work as student-developed will lead to disqualification.

**Enquiries.** All queries may be addressed to the SAH 2026 Project Expo Organising Committee.

## 8. Enquiries and Organising Committee

Students may approach the Programme Faculty Coordinator for their own programme in the first instance. Queries of a general nature may be sent to the Organising Committee by email.

| # | Organising Committee Member | Programme / Role                         |
|---|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Dr. S. Parthasarathy        | Project Expo – Campus SPoC               |
| 2 | Dr. Rishikumar              | MECH & RAI Programme Faculty Coordinator |
| 3 | Dr. S. Veluchamy            | ECE & CCE Programme Faculty Coordinator  |
| 4 | Dr. K. Ashwini              | CSE Program Faculty Coordinator          |
| 5 | Dr. IR Oviya                | AI & CYS Programme Faculty Coordinator   |

| Channel                | Details                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Email                  | sah@ch.amrita.edu                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Website — full details | <a href="https://smartamritahackathon.tech/events/project-expo">https://smartamritahackathon.tech/events/project-expo</a> — problem statements, registration link, formats, FAQs and announcements. |



**Scan for everything about SAH 2026 – Project Expo**

*Or write to [sah@ch.amrita.edu](mailto:sah@ch.amrita.edu)*

Issued by

**The Organising Committee, Smart Amrita Hackathon (SAH) 2026**

*Amrita School of Engineering and Computing, Chennai Campus*

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